Oral Guardians

GDCH, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, has emerged as a public dental powerhouse—advancing clinical training, driving research and extending quality oral healthcare to underserved communities

By **ISRARUDDIN CHISHTY**

Long marked by developmental imbalances, Maharashtra's Marathwada region hasn't always had access to quality healthcare or medical education. Yet in what was once Aurangabad—now Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar—a government dental college quietly began rewriting that script. Founded in 1982 with just 30 BDS seats, the Government Dental College & Hospital (GDCH) has since grown into one of the state's most advanced dental institutions. Today, it admits 63 undergraduate students each year, alongside 27 MDS candidates and 11 dental fellows—expanding its reach through policy, infrastructure and purpose.

What sets GDCH apart is not just capacity, but the environment it has built—one that combines clinical rigour with self-reliant training and a forward-looking technological foundation. "The foundation I received at GDCH was rock solid," says Dr Archana Badarke, an alumna who later trained in the US. "Dentistry in the US is highly digitised and assistant-driven. But because of the way we were taught at GDCH—hands-on and self-reliant—I could function smoothly even when the technology failed."

The institute is equipped with the most advanced diagnostics and treatment technologies available in the public sector—CAD/CAM systems for computer-aided design and manufacture of dental prosthetics, CBCT and OPG machines for detailed imaging, AI-assisted radiology etc. Its mobile dental van brings these services to rural areas, where access remains a challenge. Dr Rohit Khatri, another alumnus who is a professor at GDCH, Jaipur, calls it a benchmark. "Very few public institutions offer the kind of infrastructure GDCH, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar, does," he says. "It's not just meeting the minimum norms; it's staying ahead of the curve."

AHEAD OF THE CURVE

The college has also grown into a research-oriented institution. "In the past five years, we have secured 80 copyrights and numerous national and international patents. Just last year, our faculty and students published around 600 research papers," says dean Dr Maya Indurkar, who

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"We are already among the top dental institutions in Maharashtra. With the kind of research, infrastructure and collaborations we are building, we aim to become a national centre of excellence in public dental education"

DR MAYA S. INDURKAR
Dean & Professor, GDCH, Chhatrapati Sambhajinagar

